



REQUEST FOR QUALIFICATIONS

INDEPENDENT FINANCIAL AUDIT SERVICES

DATE ISSUED: April 20, 2026

VILLAGE OF SARANAC LAKE
39 MAIN ST, SUITE 9
SARANAC LAKE, NY 12983
518-891-4150

VILLAGE OF SARANAC LAKE
REQUEST FOR QUALIFICATIONS (RFQ)
INDEPENDENT FINANCIAL AUDIT SERVICES
DATE ISSUED: April 20, 2026
RESPONSES DUE: May 8, 2026

1. INTRODUCTION

The Village of Saranac Lake ("Village") is seeking statements of qualifications from independent certified public accountants and/or auditing firms to provide third-party financial audit services.

This RFQ is issued pursuant to a resolution of the Village Board of Trustees directing the procurement of independent auditing services to ensure transparency, accountability, and sound financial management.

2. PURPOSE

The purpose of this RFQ is to identify a qualified firm to:

- Conduct a comprehensive, independent audit of Village finances
- Provide a clear assessment of the Village's financial condition
- Evaluate internal controls and financial practices
- Recommend improvements consistent with New York State requirements and best practices

3. NATURE OF PROCUREMENT

This RFQ is issued in accordance with:

- New York State General Municipal Law §103 (professional services exception)
- Village procurement policies
- New York State Office of the State Comptroller (OSC) guidance on auditing services

Selection will be based on qualifications, experience, and technical approach, with cost to be negotiated with the selected firm.

4. SCOPE OF SERVICES

Consistent with the Board's resolution, the selected firm shall perform the following:

A. Financial Audit

- Conduct a full independent audit of Village financial records
- Evaluate financial statements for accuracy and completeness

B. Asset Verification

- Identify and verify all Village assets, including:
 - Real property
 - Equipment
 - Financial holdings

C. Account Identification

- Identify all Village financial accounts, including:
 - Bank accounts
 - Investment accounts
 - Other financial instruments
- Verify balances, status, and controls

D. Purchasing Policy Review

- Review the Village's purchasing policy
- Evaluate compliance with:
 - General Municipal Law §§103 and 104-b
 - Local policy and procedures
- Assess real-world application and adherence

E. Internal Controls Assessment

- Evaluate adequacy of internal financial controls
- Identify risks, deficiencies, or gaps
- Provide actionable recommendations

F. Reporting

- Provide a comprehensive written audit report
- Present findings publicly to the Village Board
- Ensure report is suitable for public posting

G. Corrective Action Support

- Assist in development of a corrective action plan
- Provide recommendations for implementation within 60 days

5. TIMELINE

- RFQ Issued: April 20, 2026
- Responses Due: May 8, 2026
- Selection: May 22, 2026
- Audit Completion: Within 120 days of engagement, unless extended by the Village Board

6. MINIMUM QUALIFICATIONS

Firms must demonstrate:

- Licensure as a Certified Public Accountant (CPA) in New York State
- Experience performing municipal audits in New York State
- Familiarity with:
 - OSC reporting requirements
 - GASB standards
 - Municipal fund accounting
- Experience evaluating internal controls and compliance systems

7. SUBMISSION REQUIREMENTS

Respondents must submit:

- Firm profile and background
- Description of relevant municipal audit experience
- Qualifications of key personnel
- Description of audit methodology and approach
- Experience with similar engagements
- References (minimum of 3 municipal clients)
- Disclosure of any conflicts of interest
- Proof of professional liability insurance

Optional

- Preliminary cost estimate or fee structure (for informational purposes only)

8. EVALUATION CRITERIA

The Village will evaluate submissions based on:

- Relevant municipal audit experience
- Qualifications of personnel
- Understanding of scope and methodology
- Demonstrated ability to meet timeline
- References and past performance

The Village reserves the right to:

- Request additional information
- Conduct interviews
- Negotiate scope and fees with selected firm

9. SUBMISSION INSTRUCTIONS

Responses are due no later than 2:00 PM on Friday, May 8, 2026

Submit to:

Bachana Tsiklauri, Village Manager
Village of Saranac Lake
39 Main Street, Suite 9
Saranac Lake, NY 12983
manager@saranaclakeny.gov

Kelly Brunette, Mayor
Village of Saranac Lake
39 Main Street, Suite 9
Saranac Lake, NY 12983
mayorbrunette@saranaclakeny.gov

Electronic submissions are required and must be received by the deadline at:
manager@saranaclakeny.gov and mayorbrunette@saranaclakeny.gov

Late submissions will not be accepted.

10. RESERVATIONS AND CONDITIONS

The Village reserves the right to:

- Reject any or all submissions
- Waive informalities
- Select the firm deemed most qualified
- Terminate the engagement at any time

This RFQ does not obligate the Village to award a contract or pay any costs incurred in preparation of a response.

11. PUBLIC PROCESS REQUIREMENTS

Consistent with the Board's resolution:

- Proposals may be reviewed publicly by the Village Board
- The final audit report will be:
 - Presented at a public meeting
 - Made available online

12. NON-DISCRIMINATION

The Village of Saranac Lake is an equal opportunity employer and encourages submissions from MWBE firms.